

User Evaluation Report

Cohort 2- Group 1

Members

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1. Methodology

a) Recruitments

Participants were selected from other teams working on the same project. Although the initial suggestion was to choose from within the cohort, it was clarified that selecting participants from different cohorts was also an option. A total of 4 participants evaluated the system.

b) Data collection tools and data

- **Think-Aloud Protocol:** Participants were asked to verbalize what they are thinking as they are doing the tasks and navigating the game. It helps to capture the insights into their decision making process in real time, as it might be hard for them to remember after all the tasks.
- **Severity Ratings:** Participants were asked to rate the severity of each problem they encountered on a 5-point scale (1=Minor, 5=Major)
- **Observation:** We observed users as they interacted with the game to note usability issues and areas with problem

c) Procedure

1. **Preparation:** Participants were provided with an information sheet detailing the study purpose and how the data would be used. They also signed consent forms.
2. **Game Introduction:** Each participant was provided with a brief about the game, its features and the purpose of the evaluation.
3. **Evaluation Tasks:** Each participant was asked to complete specific tasks. Evaluation tasks were designed to assess the user experience in various areas, including gameplay initiation, task management, and satisfaction (see Appendix A for task details).
4. **Observation and Feedback:** We have noted our user interactions, points where the participants are confused and frustrated. After finishing the gameplay, participants provided feedback for the problems they encountered and gave severity ratings for them.

2. Usability Problem Table

ID	Usability problems found by users	Users' severity rating (1-5)	Description	User feedback
1	Events clustered at the start	3	All events occur in the first two minutes, leaving the last three minutes uneventful	"If there was more event or if the events were more spaced out across the game, it would have been more engaging. "
2	Confusing leaderboard input	2	There is no clear "Enter your name" prompt and it makes the leaderboard confusing. Users think it's only displaying a score.	"A clear 'Enter your name here ' box would make it obvious what to do." "Adding a label to make it clear you're mean to type here would make it 10 times easier"
3	Not obvious space is unpause	4	Users struggled to unpause the game due to controls not being obvious.	"Labelling the controls onscreen or having a tutorial page may make it more obvious"
4	Right-click to remove building choice is not obvious	3	Users can remove buildings if they chose wrong buildings by clicking the right click but the feature is not obvious.	"The feature isn't communicated clearly. If there was any explanation for the controls, it would've been helpful. "
5	Can place buildings where they shouldn't go	3	Clicking rapidly can cause buildings to place in the bottom left without collision detection.	"Doesn't ruin the gameplay but a bit weird but that's exploitable, especially to achieve some achievements"

Appendix A

Tasks

1. Start the game and timer, as the game will be starting from paused.
Purpose: Evaluate if the user can easily start the game and timer.
 2. Place one of each type of the building.
Purpose: Test if the user understands the placement restrictions and whether they find the building categories and functionality clear.
 3. Respond to the first event. What is the current event?
Purpose: Evaluate how users react to an event and whether the event notification and information is clear.
 4. Try to keep the satisfaction above 80% as long as it's possible.
Purpose: Observe how users manage the campus to achieve high satisfaction. Assess if they understand the relationship between events and its impact on the satisfaction bar.
 5. Play a full 5 minute game while balancing the buildings, reacting to all events and maintaining a high satisfaction level.
Purpose: See how users manage their time while balancing everything.
 6. After finishing the game, add your name to the leaderboard.
Purpose: Test whether users can view their scores in the leaderboard. See if the leaderboard information displayed in an understandable format and whether the scores are accurately recorded.
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